

NM-2019-07: H2S alarm during TK-401 confined space entry

Incident / Near-Miss Report: NM-2019-07 Category: near_miss_toxic_gas

Date: 2019-08-24 Area: Area 4 Equipment: TK-401

Title: H2S alarm during TK-401 confined space entry

NARRATIVE:

During desludging inside TK-401, personal H2S monitor alarmed at 12 ppm approximately 40 minutes after entry. Entry gas test HAD PASSED. Investigation: forced air purge was shortened to ~2 h (procedure requires 4 h) due to schedule pressure on the monsoon outage; disturbing settled sludge re-released H2S. Workers exited safely.

ROOT CAUSE: Shortened pre-entry purge + sludge disturbance re-releasing H2S; schedule pressure.

PRECURSOR CONDITIONS: confined space entry; TK-401/Area 4; monsoon window high sludge load; purge duration below 4 h; initial gas test passed

CORRECTIVE ACTIONS: SOP-ET-005 to mandate minimum 4 h purge and 30-min repeat gas tests.

Associated permit: PTW-2019-0288

Reported to: M. Pillai (Safety Officer)